

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 5

APUSH-SAQ5-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Period 4: 1800–1848

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of Jacksonian politics argues that the 1820s and 1830s marked a major expansion of democratic participation for many white men. According to this interpretation, the decline of property qualifications, party organization, campaign rallies, and higher voter turnout made politics more open and competitive than it had been in the early republic.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of democracy and exclusion argues that Jacksonian politics expanded participation for some Americans while reinforcing the political exclusion of others. According to this interpretation, the same period that celebrated the “common man” also restricted the rights of women, African Americans, and Native peoples and used state power to support removal and racial hierarchy.

(a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of Jacksonian democracy.

(b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.

(c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing expanded political participation among white men, while Source B emphasizes exclusion, racial hierarchy, gender limits, or coercive policies affecting Native peoples and African Americans.

(b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as expanded white male suffrage, the rise of mass political parties, nominating conventions, campaign rallies, increased voter turnout, the Democratic Party, the Whig Party, or popular campaigning.

(c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as women’s exclusion from voting, African American disfranchisement in many states, Indian Removal, the Trail of Tears, limits on free Black rights, slavery’s expansion, or racialized definitions of citizenship and political belonging.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should treat Jacksonian democracy as both expansionary and exclusionary. It should explain who gained greater political participation and who remained excluded or harmed by the same political culture.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ5-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Period 5: 1844–1877

Period: Period 5: 1844–1877

Theme: SOC — Social Structures

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

A freedwoman writing to a Freedmen’s Bureau official, South Carolina, 1866.

“My husband and I have agreed to work this year’s crop, but the planter says our children must labor in the field instead of attending the school opened near the church. We know the meaning of a contract if both sides keep it. We ask that wages be written, that families not be separated, and that our children have time to learn letters. Freedom should mean more than choosing whose cotton we pick.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the argument made in the source.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader struggles over freedom and labor during Reconstruction.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as emancipation, Reconstruction, the creation of the Freedmen’s Bureau, the transition from slavery to free labor, Black Codes, labor contracts, sharecropping, or African American efforts to build schools and families after slavery.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s perspective as a freedwoman and worker shaped her emphasis on family autonomy, written wages, children’s education, protection from coercion, and a broader meaning of freedom beyond plantation labor.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader struggle, such as conflict between freedpeople and former enslavers over labor discipline, the meaning of free labor, access to education, family independence, landownership, legal rights, or the limits of federal protection in the South.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should emphasize African American agency during Reconstruction. It should connect labor contracts, education, and family autonomy to freedpeople’s efforts to define freedom after emancipation.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ5-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described data chart created for this practice exam.

The chart is titled “Energy, Oil Imports, and Public Policy in the United States, 1960–1980.”

Indicator | 1960 | 1973 | 1980

Share of U.S. petroleum consumption supplied by imports | about 18% | about 35% | about 40%

Average gasoline price | relatively low | rising sharply | much higher

Federal attention to fuel efficiency and conservation | limited | increasing | significant

Public concern about dependence on foreign oil | moderate | high after oil embargo | very high

Common visible effects | highway growth and suburban commuting | gasoline lines in some regions
| smaller cars, conservation campaigns, energy policy debates

The chart notes that figures are approximate and intended to show broad historical trends.

- (a) Describe one change in the United States reflected in the chart.
- (b) Explain one international or domestic factor that contributed to the change described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one political, economic, or cultural consequence of the energy changes reflected in the chart.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as rising dependence on imported oil, higher gasoline prices, increased federal attention to energy conservation, public concern about foreign oil, or changes in consumer behavior.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as the 1973 oil embargo, OPEC, Middle East conflict, suburbanization and automobile dependence, declining relative domestic oil production, inflation, environmental concerns, or increased energy consumption after World War II.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as energy policy debates, fuel-efficiency standards, conservation campaigns, smaller cars, economic strain, inflationary pressure, environmental regulation, debates over nuclear power, or public questioning of U.S. dependence on foreign oil.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect energy use to both foreign policy and domestic life. It should avoid treating the energy crisis as only a temporary gasoline shortage and should explain how it shaped politics, consumer habits, environmental debates, and economic concerns.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ5-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Period 6: 1865–1898

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: GEO — Geography and the Environment

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which federal conservation and resource policies changed conflicts over land and natural resources in the American West from 1870 to 1920.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Original simulated editorial from a mining and railroad trade newspaper, Denver, Colorado, 1878; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper-style excerpt.

“The West will not prosper if timber, coal, silver, and grazing lands are locked away by distant officials. Railroads, mines, and towns require access to the resources that make settlement possible. Eastern reformers praise scenery, but western workers know that mountains and forests must feed families as well as inspire tourists.”

Sourcing Cues: The editorial reflects the viewpoint of business interests and western boosters who favored resource extraction and local economic development.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Described federal land map created for this practice exam, western United States, 1891–1916.

Source Type: Described map.

The map shows expanding areas of federally reserved forests in the Rocky Mountains, Pacific Northwest, California, Arizona, and New Mexico. It also marks several national parks, including Yellowstone, Yosemite, Mount Rainier, and Mesa Verde, as well as major reclamation projects along western rivers. A note explains that federal land reservations increased sharply after the Forest Reserve Act and Progressive Era conservation policies.

Sourcing Cues: The map emphasizes the growing federal role in managing forests, parks, water, and public lands.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated statement by a federal forestry official, Washington, D.C., 1906; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Government policy statement.

“Conservation does not mean refusing use. It means planned use. Forests should supply timber, protect watersheds, prevent destructive fires, and serve the public over generations. Private companies may profit from public resources, but only under rules that prevent waste and monopoly.”

Sourcing Cues: The statement reflects Progressive Era conservation ideas emphasizing expertise, efficiency, public interest, and regulated use rather than complete preservation.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Original simulated petition from small ranchers and sheep growers, Idaho, 1908; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Petition-style excerpt.

“New grazing permits require fees and rules that large outfits can manage more easily than small herders. We do not oppose protecting grass or water, but regulations written far from our valleys can decide who survives. Public land has long been our pasture, and access should not be sold to those with the strongest political friends.”

Sourcing Cues: The petition reflects tensions between federal regulation, local custom, small producers, and larger commercial users.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated essay by a preservationist club member, San Francisco, California, 1913; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Reform essay excerpt.

“A valley carved by ancient ice and filled with forests should not be judged only by the water it can deliver to a city. If every beautiful place must prove its usefulness in pipes, dams, or profits, then the nation will discover too late that it has traded inheritance for convenience.”

Sourcing Cues: The essay reflects preservationist criticism of development projects and emphasizes scenic, spiritual, and national value in protected landscapes.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Reclamation data table created for this practice exam, western United States, 1902–1918.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled “Selected Federal Reclamation Trends.”

Period | Reclamation projects authorized | Main stated goals | Common conflicts

1902–1906 | several early irrigation projects | support family farms, manage water, promote settlement | costs, water rights, engineering delays

1907–1912 | projects expanded across arid western states | increase agricultural production and stabilize settlement | unequal access to water, debt, local disputes

1913–1918 | continued expansion and review | improve efficiency and repayment | conflict between small farmers, cities, and large landholders

Sourcing Cues: The table shows how federal water policy connected conservation, settlement, agriculture, and disputes over access.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Original simulated testimony from a Pueblo community representative to a regional land hearing, New Mexico, 1915; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Primary testimony excerpt.

“Officials speak of forests, irrigation, and public benefit, but our fields depend on water used by our village before these surveys were drawn. When grazing rules, dams, or outside claims change the streams, they change our ceremonies, crops, and responsibilities to one another. Public land policy should not erase older communities.”

Sourcing Cues: The testimony reflects the perspective of a Native community whose land and water use could be affected by conservation, reclamation, and federal land policies.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which federal conservation and resource policies changed conflicts over land and natural resources in the American West from 1870 to 1920. The thesis must make an argument, such as that federal policy changed conflicts by expanding national authority and expert management while intensifying disputes among businesses, small producers, preservationists, cities, farmers, and Native communities.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as westward expansion, railroad development, mining, ranching, industrialization, Progressive reform, closing of the frontier, urban water demand, public land policy, or federal support for western settlement.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents to support a coherent argument about extraction, federal land management, conservation, preservation, grazing, irrigation, local conflict, or Native land and water claims.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Yellowstone National Park, Yosemite, Forest Reserve Act, U.S. Forest Service, Gifford Pinchot, John Muir, Hetch Hetchy controversy, Newlands Reclamation Act, National Park Service, Homestead Act, Desert Land Act, or Theodore Roosevelt’s conservation policies.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze business newspapers’ interest in extraction, federal foresters’ Progressive faith in expert management, small ranchers’ concerns about regulation, preservationists’ scenic and spiritual values, or Pueblo testimony defending older land and water relationships.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as distinguishing conservation from preservation, explaining that federal policies both protected resources and enabled development, showing how “public interest” meant different things to different groups, or recognizing that western resource conflicts involved class, region, environment, and sovereignty.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that federal conservation and resource policies significantly changed western land conflicts by expanding federal authority over forests, parks, grazing, and irrigation. However, it should also show that these policies did not simply stop development. Conservation often promoted regulated use, while preservationists, businesses, small producers, cities, farmers, and Native communities disagreed over what public land should serve. Useful document groupings include extraction and western development, federal expert management, local producers, preservationist values, reclamation and irrigation, and Native community concerns. Relevant outside evidence could include the Forest Reserve Act, U.S. Forest Service, Pinchot, Muir, Hetch Hetchy, Newlands Reclamation Act, National Park Service, or Roosevelt-era conservation.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ5-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: ARC — American and Regional Culture

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the late nineteenth century through World War II, Americans experienced major changes in entertainment, communication, advertising, sports, music, literature, film, radio, and consumer culture. These developments shaped national identity while also reflecting regional, racial, ethnic, class, and generational differences.

Evaluate the extent to which mass culture changed American society from 1865 to 1945.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent to which mass culture changed American society from 1865 to 1945. The thesis must make an argument about continuity, change, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to mass

culture, such as industrialization, urbanization, immigration, rising literacy, consumer capitalism, technological innovation, the growth of national markets, the Great Migration, the 1920s consumer economy, or World War II mobilization.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as yellow journalism, vaudeville, spectator sports, mail-order catalogs, advertising, phonographs, motion pictures, radio, jazz, the Harlem Renaissance, Tin Pan Alley, Hollywood, flappers, consumer credit, chain stores, national magazines, or wartime propaganda. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about how mass culture changed society.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how mass culture created more shared national experiences through new media and consumer goods while older regional, racial, ethnic, religious, and class divisions continued to shape how Americans produced and received culture.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that mass culture could both unify and divide Americans, comparing producers and consumers of culture, showing how African American cultural production influenced national culture while facing racism, or distinguishing commercial entertainment from political communication and reform.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not simply list inventions or entertainment forms. It should explain how mass culture changed American society by creating shared symbols, celebrities, consumer habits, and national media networks. Strong responses should also recognize limits: access and representation differed by race, class, gender, region, and generation, and mass culture often produced conflict as well as unity.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ5

· APUSH-SAQ5-001: Unit 4; Period 4: 1800–1848; perspectives include modern secondary historians of Jacksonian democratic expansion and Jacksonian exclusion; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast expanded white male political participation with continued exclusion of women, African Americans, and Native peoples; historical development is Jacksonian democracy, mass parties, suffrage expansion, and racialized limits of democracy; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating Jacksonian democracy as either fully democratic or entirely undemocratic without specifying who gained and who was excluded.

· APUSH-SAQ5-002: Unit 5; Period 5: 1844–1877; perspective is freedwoman petitioning the Freedmen’s Bureau during Reconstruction; source type is original simulated primary text; source viewpoint emphasizes wages, written contracts, family autonomy, children’s schooling, and the meaning of freedom beyond plantation labor; historical development is emancipation, free labor, Freedmen’s Bureau intervention, and freedpeople’s Reconstruction priorities; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to labor rights and African American agency; misconception targeted is treating Reconstruction as only a federal political process rather than a struggle over everyday freedom, family, work, and education.

· APUSH-SAQ5-003: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; perspectives include U.S. consumers, policymakers, suburban commuters, oil-producing nations, environmental advocates, and

businesses affected by energy costs; non-text source type is plain-text energy data chart; visual/data/map pattern is imported oil share, gasoline prices, conservation policy, public concern, and visible effects such as gasoline lines and smaller cars; historical development is the 1970s energy crisis, OPEC-related oil shocks, automobile dependence, and conservation policy; reasoning path is causation linking international oil politics, domestic consumption patterns, and political/economic/cultural consequences; misconception targeted is treating the energy crisis as only a short-term gasoline shortage rather than a turning point in policy, foreign dependence, and consumer behavior.

· APUSH-DBQ5-001: Unit 6 primary with Unit 7 connections; Periods 6–7 / Cross-Period; DBQ topic is federal conservation and resource policies changing western land and natural-resource conflicts from 1870 to 1920; document types include mining/railroad trade newspaper editorial, described federal land map, federal forestry policy statement, rancher and sheep-grower petition, preservationist essay, reclamation data table, and Pueblo community testimony; document perspectives include western business boosters, federal conservation experts, small ranchers, preservationists, irrigated farmers, cities seeking water, Native communities, and federal land managers; main argument paths include extraction versus regulation, conservation versus preservation, federal expertise, grazing access, irrigation and reclamation, public land conflict, and older Native/community water claims; outside evidence possibilities include Yellowstone, Yosemite, Forest Reserve Act, U.S. Forest Service, Gifford Pinchot, John Muir, Hetch Hetchy, Newlands Reclamation Act, National Park Service, Homestead Act, Desert Land Act, and Roosevelt conservation policies; sourcing opportunities include business pro-development POV, Progressive expert-management purpose, small producer concerns, preservationist audience, reclamation policy goals, and Native testimony on community land and water; visual/data/map types include described western federal land map and reclamation projects data table.

· APUSH-LEQ5-001: Units 6–7; Periods 6–7 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is mass culture’s impact on American society from 1865 to 1945; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include yellow journalism, vaudeville, spectator sports, mail-order catalogs, advertising, phonographs, motion pictures, radio, jazz, Harlem Renaissance, Tin Pan Alley, Hollywood, flappers, consumer credit, chain stores, national magazines, and wartime propaganda; complexity path is explaining that mass culture created shared national experiences while remaining shaped by race, class, gender, ethnicity, region, generation, and commercial power; misconception targeted is treating mass culture as merely entertainment or technology rather than a force shaping identity, consumption, politics, and social conflict.